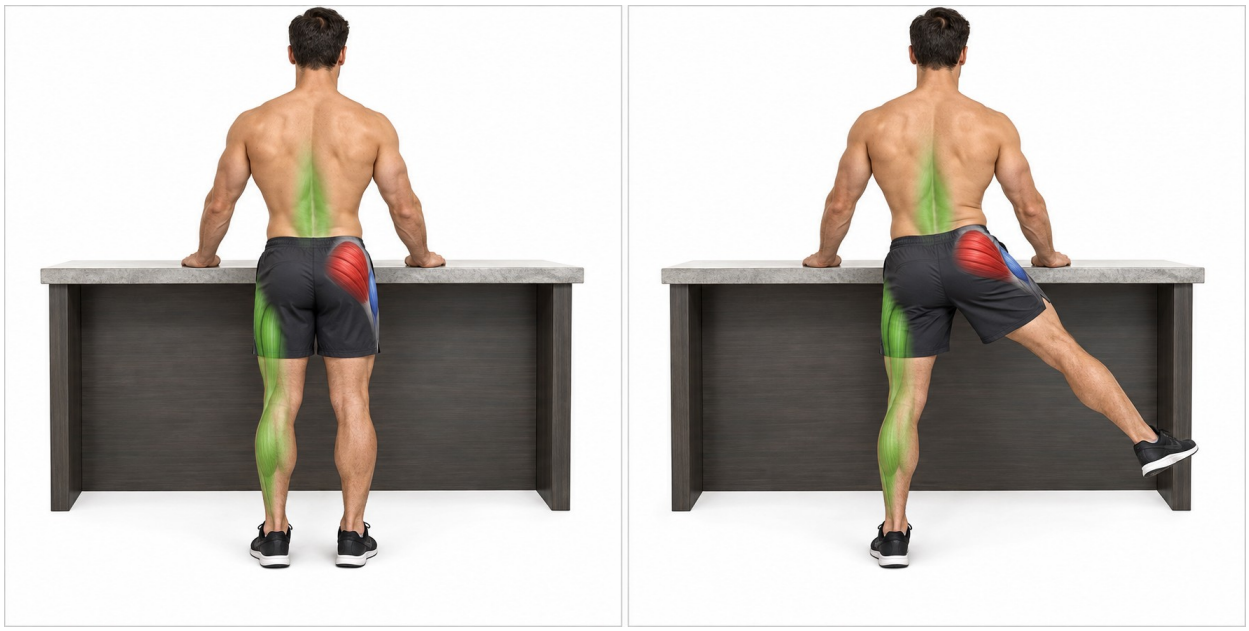
Supported side leg lift

Hip abduction / 6-10 each side



START / steady stance FINISH / small side lift

MAIN: Gluteus medius and minimus lift the thigh away from the midline.

SECONDARY: Tensor fasciae latae assists; other hip muscles coordinate the leg position.

BASE / SUPPORT: The stance-side hip, trunk and ankle muscles steady the pelvis; hands assist balance on a fixed support.

01 / Check the setup

Start without a band beside a fixed counter or stable chair. Leave room to move one leg sideways.

02 / Set the base and brace

Stand tall with the pelvis level and stance knee soft. Keep toes facing mostly forward.

03 / Move with control

Lift the free leg a short distance to the side while breathing normally, then lower with control.

04 / Limit the range and return

Stop before the pelvis tilts, toes rotate upward or the trunk leans away. Keep the motion small and deliberate.

WATCH FOR: The movement comes from the hip, not a swinging leg or sideways bend of the waist.
EASIER: Use a smaller lift with more hand support; omit if the stance hip or knee is painful.

Soft joints, normal breathing. Colours describe exercise roles, not measured activation. Hidden muscles are named in text. No fixed resistance is prescribed.

Stop for pain, new numbness or weakness, dizziness, loss of grip, moving supports or damaged bands. Keep the recoil path clear. Follow manufacturer limits and individual clinical restrictions.

Sources: NHS - Strength exercises. Full source links: project100.fit/downloads/kinetics/index.html